

Planning

IT Product Development

Innopolis University, 2026

Agenda

- Discussion questions
- Types of planning
- Strategic
- Tactical
- Expectations

Discussion questions

What is planning?

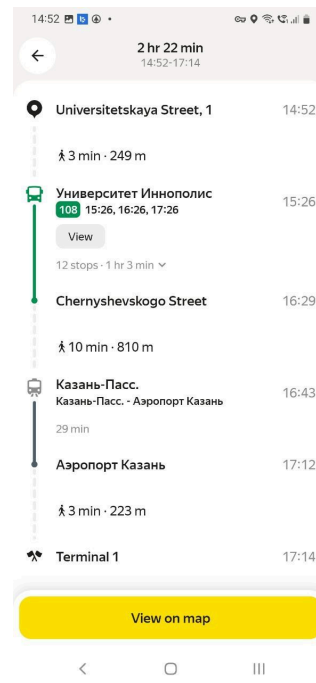
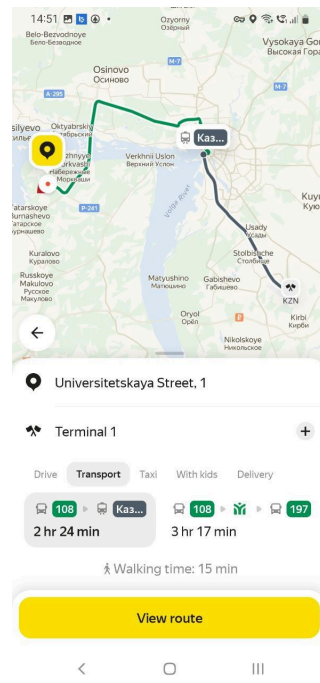
Why do people plan?

How do you plan to plan? :)

What types of planning do you know?

Strategic

One way to remember what you need from a strategic plan is to think of a navigation app.



Planning

Strategic

- Long term (more than 4 iterations)
- Achieve goals
- Keep in mind the threshold of success

Tactical

- Situational
- Short term

Strategic

- Define success
- Develop a roadmap
- Monitor progress
- Make contingency plans

Strategic: define success

- Be realistic
- Make it testable
- Make sure all stakeholders agree

Warning! 80% of pain comes from skipping this step.

Strategic: develop a roadmap

- Decompose how to achieve success into steps
- Find a “zoom level” that works for your project

Strategic: monitor progress

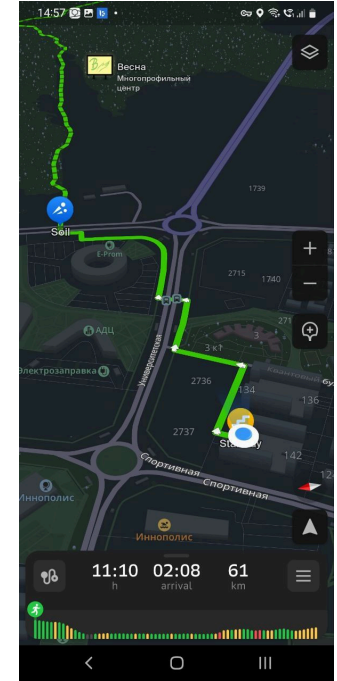
- Where are we in the project right now?
- How much was done?
- How much more do we have to do?
- Are we on track to make deadlines?
- Are we on track to complete promised deliverables?

Strategic: make contingency plans

- Think of multiple options
- Define alternative solutions
- Identify “point of no return” decisions
- Identify risks

Tactical: requirements

- SMART tasks (goals)
- Define who is responsible
- Review completed work
- Adjust to fix discovered problems



Tactical: SMART tasks (goals)

- **S**pecific
- **M**easurable
- **A**chievable
- **R**elevant
- **T**ime-bound

Tactical: responsibility

- Every task has a specific person responsible for completing it
- There is a separate person who verifies that it was done

Tactical: review and adjust

Review

- Iteration demo
- What went wrong?
- What went right?

Adjust

- What steps should we take to improve iterations?

Tactical pitfall

Using Scrum as an excuse not to have strategic planning:

- Can't manage customer expectations.
- Can't predict how much time larger features will take.
- You will end up writing code just for the sake of writing code.

Tactical frameworks

There are different tactical approaches like Scrum. The specific approach is chosen based on what works best for:

- your team
- your project
- the tactical requirements

Warning! When you pick a framework, you must use all of it! If you removed or added something, you must provide an explanation!

Quiz

What is strategic planning?

What is tactical planning?

What will happen if we ignore strategic planning?

What will happen if we lack tactical planning?

Questions?